20 AUGUST 2026

Coding Café

Administrivia

Outline

1. Meet the Team
2. Course Structure
3. Policies & AI

INSTRUCTOR

Raghav Awasty

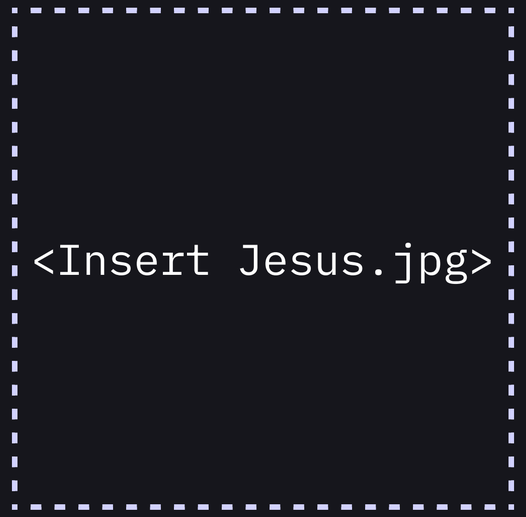
Data Scientist, Plaksha University

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Fields of Interests:

- Data for Social Impact
- Engaging Learning Environments
- Tinkering on Small Projects with Students
- Local Toolage
- Cracking (mostly well landing) Jokes



TEACHING FELLOWS

RITVIK RANJAN
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Face Reveal Soon!

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What this course is about?

- Introduction to core programming concepts
- Building an intuition for chaining together logical components to build solutions
- Exploring the various programming paradigms
- Applying programming techniques to solve fun, thought-provoking problems
- Working with the tools programmers actually use — the terminal, Git and GitHub
- Relating what you write in Python to the C you meet in FM111
- Building a strong foundation for advanced courses
- Gain programming fluency in Python

COURSE CALENDAR

Getting set up

01 Environments & first programs

02 Dev-Tools I — the terminal

The building blocks

03 Variables, data types & operators

04 Conditionals & branching · Quiz 1

05 Loops & iteration

Working like a programmer

06 Dev-Tools II — Git & GitHub

07 Functions & modules · Quiz 2

08 Strings & lists

09 In-person assignment 1

Structure & scale

10 Dictionaries, sets & file handling · Quiz 3

11 Object-oriented programming I

12 Object-oriented programming II

Putting it to work

13 Libraries & automation · Quiz 4

14 In-person assignment 2

15 Revision & wrap-up

ASSESSMENTS

20% TBD

Final Programming Exam

40% Lab submissions

Lab Work

Weeks 4, 7, 10 and 13 [4 x 5]

20%

Quizzes

20% In-person, in lab Weeks 9 and 14 [2 x 10]

Assignments

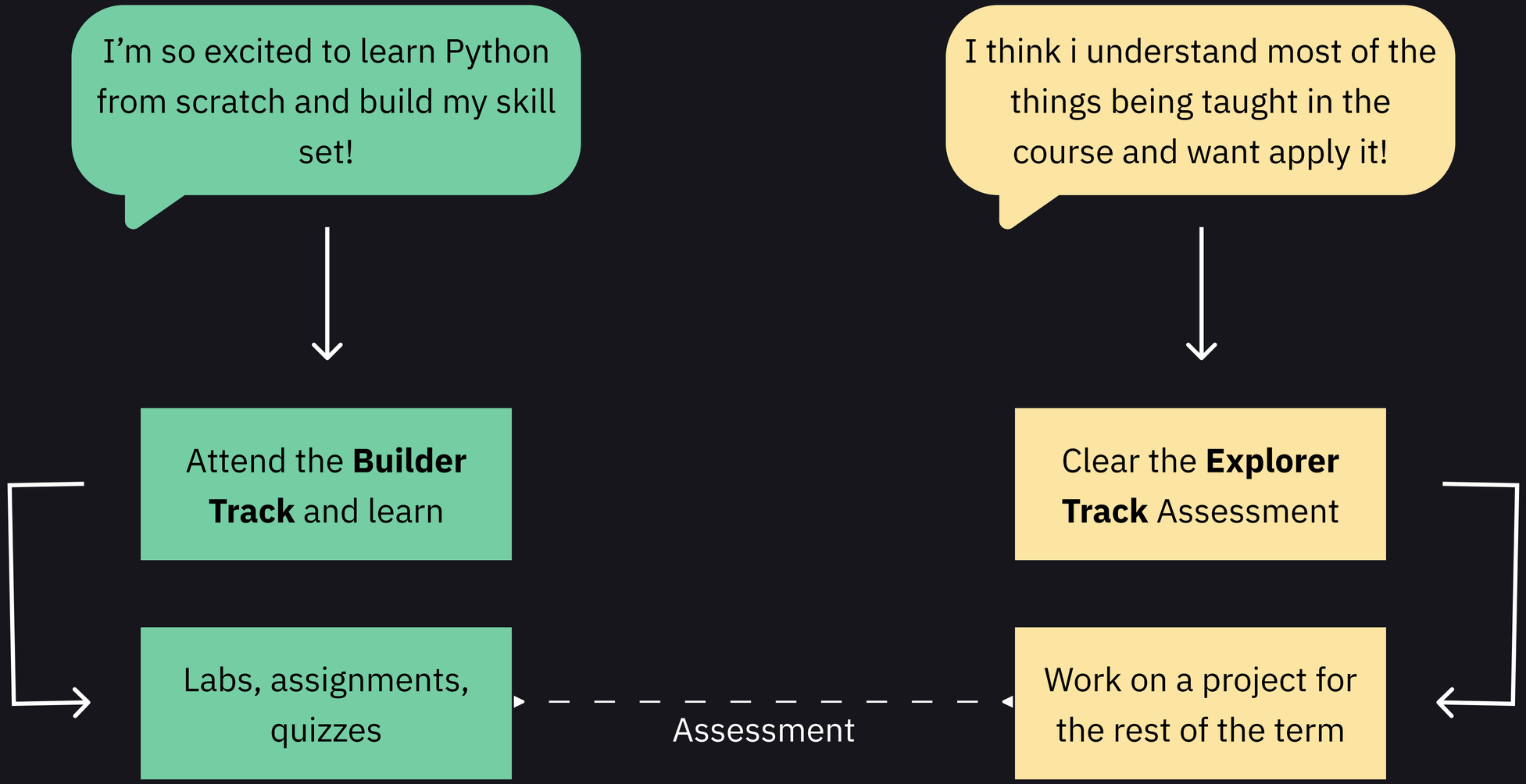
Challenges throughout the course

10%*

Bonus

*may or may not be implemented based on course pace

THE TWO TRACKS



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LATE POLICY

> An assignment submitted late is better than an assignment never submitted.
>
> — A WISE MAN



- In-person assignments: held in lab in Weeks 9 and 14 — there is nothing to turn in late.
- Missed an assessment for a documented reason? Apply for a makeup.
- Lab exercises: this is both submission based and in-class no penalty for submitting lab work up to +2 days, 11:00pm from the day the lab is scheduled.

Attendance:

- No points for attendance; submissions and in-class quizzes serve as markers

Feedback mechanisms

Office Hours:

- Raghav (tentative) - Monday and Wednesday, 3:00 - 4:30 PM
- Teaching Fellows - TBD

- Approach every lab and assignment as a challenge to enhance learning. Give yourself the best opportunity to accomplish it yourself.
- When facing roadblock, talk to the TFs and/or Student Tutors or your course peers for hints.
- If you end up getting meaningful help from others, acknowledge them in your submission.
- Refrain from copying code. It’s just not worth it.

AI Use?





While Using AI

01
Slow Down

Don’t be in a rush to generate and submit answers. Ask the AI to first explain the question to you before you ask it for the solution.

02
Read

Once you get an answer, that shouldn’t be the end. Read through what the AI gives you first. Try to understand it, ask it to explain if you don’t.

03
Re-type

Don’t copy paste, re-type the code yourself. That in itself will build some of that muscle memory.

04
Revisit

Go back to the answer if you are under a time crunch to submit (ideally, don’t be). Spend some time understanding the answer.

While Using AI

If you come out of an interaction with AI for academic work without the feeling of “I understand it now”, don’t settle. Ask for help, ask questions.

20 AUGUST 2026

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